TOPIC REPORTS: DATA PROTECTION

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

STRATEGIES, PLANS AND POLICIES · LEGISLATION AND REGULATION · DATA PROTECTION · REGIONAL COLLABORATION · STANDARDS · PUBLIC DEBATE AND PARTICIPATION IN POLICYMAKING

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Angola

PUBLISHED DATA-PROTECTION FINES

- **Deliberação sobre processos contravencionais** — Agência de Protecção de Dados, 11 October 2026

  Angola's data protection agency publishes its register of fines: 15 sanctions between 2022 and 2026, from US$75,000 to US$525,000, with banks, telecoms operators, the national airline and the Luanda water utility among those penalised. The largest 2026 fine was for storing personal data in a cloud abroad without authorisation.

Benin

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY

- **IA et flux transfrontaliers en Afrique : L'appel de l'Apdp-Bénin à une gouvernance fiable des données** — La Nation (Bénin), 3 September 2026

  The president of Benin's personal data protection authority (APDP), Luciano Hounkponou, set out four measures for trusted cross-border data flows at a regulators' forum held with MTN Group's fintech summit in Johannesburg on 1–3 September 2026: stronger legal frameworks, secure and interoperable systems, shared governance and user education. He also called for closer cooperation between data protection and financial supervisors.

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY SWORN OFFICERS

- **17 APDP Benin officers sworn in to strengthen commitment to personal data protection** — TechReviewAfrica, 15 September 2026

  Seventeen officers of the data protection authority were sworn in before the Cotonou court of first instance on 14 September under the digital code, formally binding them to the obligations of their duties.

Burkina Faso

AUTHORISATION OF PERSONAL-DATA TRANSFERS ABROAD

- **Demande d'autorisation de transfert de données vers un pays étranger** — Commission de l'Informatique et des Libertés (CIL), Burkina Faso, 1 September 2026

> Burkina Faso's data protection authority, the CIL, publishes the form for applying to transfer personal data abroad. It asks for the foreign recipient, whether the destination country has a data protection authority, and the purpose, consent and security arrangements behind the transfer.

Cape Verde

> DELEGATION OF POWERS OVER THE INTELLIGENCE SERVICE

- **Serviço de Informações da República: Entre a defesa do Estado e os limites da democracia** — A Nacao, 8 September 2026

  Cabo Verde's prime minister delegated coordination of the intelligence service SIR to the interior minister by despacho no. 15/2026 in the Boletim Oficial. The opposition MpD calls it unconstitutional, arguing the SIR law gives the prime minister exclusive authority, and says it will challenge it. The government cites its general power of delegation; President José Maria Neves declined to comment publicly.

Congo

> NATIONAL PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION COMMISSION

- **Gouvernance : mobiliser les ressources publiques** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 17 October 2026

  Opening the National Assembly's budget session on 15 October 2026, its president Isidore Mvouba asked the Congolese government to make the National Commission for the Protection of Personal Data operational promptly. He linked digital sovereignty to control over health, civil-status, education, tax and social-protection data.

Egypt

> JOINT DECISION ON SOCIAL-MEDIA ACCOUNTS FOR UNDER-15S

- **الأعلى للإعلام» و«الاتصالات» يلزمان منصات التواصل بحماية الأطفال دون 15 عامًا«** — Youm7, 17 September 2026

  Egypt's media council and telecom regulator issued a joint decision obliging platforms to protect children under 15: no independent accounts for under-13s, an automatic and undisableable safe mode for those aged 13 to under 15, and age verification that resists circumvention while minimising the data collected for it. Platforms must review existing accounts that appear to belong to under-15s, offer a route to correct an age, and comply within three months.

- **مسار والمبادرة المصرية للحقوق الشخصية تطالبان بضمانات معلنة لحماية الأطفال على الإنترنت وصون حقوقهم** — Egyptian Initiative for Personal Rights, 29 September 2026

  Egyptian rights groups Masaar and the Egyptian Initiative for Personal Rights asked the media regulator and the telecoms regulator NTRA on 29 September 2026 to publish the full text and legal basis of their 17 September decision on children's social-media accounts, which bars independent accounts for under-13s. They also want public rules on what age-verification data is collected and kept, and no general biometric requirement.

> PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION CENTER

- **Egypt: Personal Data Protection Law Update** — Baker McKenzie, 7 October 2026

  Egypt's Personal Data Protection Center opened its electronic portal for accreditation, licence and permit applications in early October, weeks before the data-protection law's compliance grace period ends on 31 October 2026, on a law firm's account. Applying needs a Digital Egypt login tied to an Egyptian national ID, so foreign controllers and processors must act through an authorised local representative.

Eswatini

DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITY COMMUNITY OUTREACH CAMPAIGN

- **EDPA takes data protection services closer to Emaswati** — Eswatini Positive News, 17 September 2026

  Eswatini's Data Protection Authority is setting up information desks in major towns to give the public and businesses guidance on data-protection rights, responsibilities and registration. It began the outreach after finding that about eight in ten visitors to its trade fair stand had limited knowledge of the Data Protection Act.

Gabon

AUTORITE DE PROTECTION DES DONNEES A CARACTERE PERSONNEL

- **Joël Dominique Ledaga : "Pour échanger directement avec Meta, TikTok ou Instagram, il faut une réponse africaine commune"** — L'Union - Sonapresse, 4 September 2026

  Gabon's data-protection authority APDPVP has authorised the ST Digital Gabon data centre and its mirror site and logged about 715 declarations of conformity, its president Joël Dominique Ledaga said in an interview. He said the authority lacks the technical and material means its remit needs, and that dealing with Meta, TikTok or Instagram requires a common African response.

Ghana

DATA PROTECTION COMMISSION

- **Full Text: Sam George's speech at Government Accountability Series** — MyJoyOnline, 7 September 2026

  Ghana's communications ministry gave a full public account of its January–August delivery, and the arithmetic is the interesting part: 141,954 registered accounts against 5,812 logged completions on the national coders programme, 8,578 fibre cuts projected for 2026 at roughly US$2,045 a repair, and a dig-once policy still awaiting Cabinet. It also records voice over LTE rising from about 7% of traffic to 22.43% and smartphone penetration at 71.8% in June 2026.

- **DPC begins checks on data protection compliance** — Ghana News Agency, 4 October 2026

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission said it would begin spot checks and enforcement from 5 October against organisations that process personal data without registering or meeting the Data Protection Act, 2012. Its executive director said prosecution would follow where necessary.

- **DPC strengthens enforcement after registering 2,575 data controllers | Ghana News Agency** — Ghana News Agency, 13 October 2026

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission said it had registered 2,575 data controllers in 2026, more than in any previous year, and was adding spot checks, inspections and complaint investigations.

UNITED STATES HEALTH DATA-SHARING AGREEMENT

- **President Mahama Defends Rejection of U.S. Health Compact, Calls Terms 'Humiliating' and a Threat to Sovereignty** — Ghana News Global, 29 September 2026

  Ghana's President John Mahama told the Council on Foreign Relations in New York that his Cabinet rejected a US health compact because it required Ghana to share pathogen profiles and medical records and exempted US-supplied medicines from Food and Drugs Authority inspection. Reuters reported that the deal, under negotiation since November 2025, would have provided US$109 million for health over five years.

- **U.S. seeks transition from health aid dependency to country ownership – Rolf Olson | Ghana News Agency** — Ghana News Agency, 29 September 2026

  The US chargé d'affaires in Ghana, Rolf Olson, told journalists in Accra on 29 September 2026 that the health memorandum of understanding Ghana rejected was meant to taper US assistance over several years towards country ownership. He said the US invested US$82.5 million in Ghana in the administration's first year and US$53 million in FY2026, and has signed 35 bilateral health MOUs, 24 in sub-Saharan Africa.

- **US seeks changes to rejected $109m health compact with Ghana – Mahama** — MyJoyOnline, 10 October 2026

  Ghana's President John Mahama said the United States has asked to reopen talks on the roughly US$109m five-year health compact that Ghana's Cabinet rejected, with a view to amending or removing the disputed clauses. Ghana objected to provisions requiring it to give the US its pathogen profile and medical records, to counterpart funding and to limits on its Food and Drugs Authority.

DATA-PROTECTION ENFORCEMENT ACTIONS

- **Nyaho Medical Centre referred to CID over allegedly expired data protection registration** — MyJoyOnline, 12 October 2026

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission directed an Accra hospital to report to the police criminal investigations department over an expired data protection registration certificate, after an enforcement operation on 12 October. How long the registration had lapsed was not stated.

- **Data Protection Commission clamps down on organisations breaching regulations, microfinance firm and health facility referred to police for prosecution** — Graphic Online, 13 October 2026

  Ghana's Data Protection Commission began field enforcement in Accra on 12 October 2026, finding two hospitals operating with expired certificates; a microfinance firm and a health facility were referred to police for prosecution. Executive director Arnold Kavaarpuo said 2,575 data controllers registered in 2026, more than in any previous year, and that registration alone is not compliance.

Kenya

SAFEGUARDS FOR DEACTIVATING AND RECYCLING TELEPHONE NUMBERS

- **Procedures and technical safeguards for deactivation and recycling of inactive telecommunication numbering resources (CA.G.520:2026, Version 1.0)** — Communications Authority of Kenya, 1 September 2026

  The Communications Authority of Kenya published draft guidelines (CA.G.520:2026) on deactivating and recycling inactive phone numbers, open for comment until 11 September 2026 with a proposed start date of 19 September. The draft sets up a central database of deactivated and recycled numbers, quarterly reporting by operators, a *106# status check, and whitelisting for prisoners and incapacitated subscribers.

- **Kenya's new phone number rules will make recycling costlier for telcos** — TechCabal, 2 September 2026

  Kenya's Communications Authority published draft procedures for deactivating and recycling mobile numbers: deactivation only after three consecutive months without revenue-generating activity, then three further months of contact attempts by message and the details given at registration, with at-risk numbers published in national media. The document is out for consultation, with memoranda due 11 September 2026.

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

Kenya's communications regulator told a National Assembly committee that SIM deactivation and number recycling now run under its 2026 procedures: notice to the subscriber's contact after three months' inactivity, a public notice and status check before recycling after six, and whitelisting for subscribers who are sick, imprisoned or deceased. It was answering a petition against the largest operator's recycling.

- **CA to set up central database to track recycled phone numbers** — Daily Nation, 12 October 2026

  Kenya's communications regulator said it will set up a central database of recycled phone numbers, which operators must update every three months. Banks, fintechs and bulk message senders would check it before sending account messages to a number.

HIGH COURT RULING ON RIDE-HAILING DATA RETENTION

- **What High Court Ruling on Uber, Bolt and Other Ride-Hailing Taxi Mean for Kenya's Consumers** — Consumers Federation of Kenya (COFEK), 2 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court struck down a National Transport and Safety Authority rule requiring ride-hailing platforms to retain passenger and driver data for three years and hand it over on demand, finding it breached the right to privacy and the Data Protection Act 2019, the Consumers Federation of Kenya reported on 2 September 2026. The court, on a petition by Bolt, also blocked an 18% commission cap and suspended its declaration for 12 months so the government can redo the regulations.

GUIDANCE NOTES FOR CROSS-BORDER DATA TRANSFERS

- **Guidance Notes for Cross-border Data Transfers** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner (Kenya), 8 September 2026

  Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner published Guidance Notes for Cross-border Data Transfers in September 2026, with a foreword by Data Commissioner Immaculate Kassait. The 63-page document includes a compliance checklist, an application form for binding corporate rules and standard clauses for controller-to-controller and controller-to-processor transfers. It prints no issue date.

DRAFT NOTICE ON ADDITIONAL CATEGORIES OF SENSITIVE PERSONAL DATA

- **DRAFT Public Notice: Additional Categories of Sensitive Personal Data (Data Protection Act, 2019, s.47) — PDF** — Office of the Data Protection Commissioner, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner published a draft notice on 11 September 2026 adding political affiliation and trade union membership to sensitive personal data under section 47 of the Data Protection Act 2019. It applies only to data transferred from countries whose law already treats them as sensitive. Public comment is invited; no deadline is stated.

MATEY V SAFARICOM RULING ON ACCESS TO DATA-DISCLOSURE RECORDS

- **Matey v Safaricom PLC (Constitutional Miscellaneous Application E043 of 2026) [2026] KEHC 13624 (KLR), Ruling, 18 September 2026** — High Court of Kenya at Nairobi (Milimani), Constitutional and Human Rights Division; text as reported by SheriaHub from Kenya Law, 18 September 2026

  Kenya's High Court ruled on 18 September 2026 in Matey v Safaricom that Safaricom must, within 21 days, give a subscriber her subscriber details and records of every request for access to her communications, M-Pesa and transaction data, plus access logs, for March 2024 to January 2025. The court relied on the constitutional right of access to information, subject to the Data Protection Act.

DATA-PROTECTION CERTIFICATE AS A CONDITION OF DIGITAL-LENDER LICENSING

- **Stakeholders push for data sovereignty as AI conference tackles power shortages, worker exploitation** — Citizen Digital, 25 September 2026

  At the Africa AI Stakeholder Meeting in Nairobi, Kenya's deputy data commissioner John Walubengo said an agreement with the Central Bank of Kenya requires digital lenders to hold a data-protection compliance certificate before being licensed. A Schneider Electric speaker said Kenya has 0.6% of global data-centre capacity, with local facilities about 37% utilised.

DATA PROTECTION COMMISSIONER SUCCESSION

- **Kenya's Data Commissioner search comes as AI transforms data governance** — TechTrends KE, 30 September 2026

  Kenya's Public Service Commission shortlisted 13 of 152 applicants to succeed Immaculate Kassait as Data Protection Commissioner at the end of her single six-year term, with interviews on 5 October 2026.

DATA BREACH SUIT AGAINST ABSA BANK KENYA

- **How Absa Bank's employee data leak brought down multi-billion business** — The Standard, 12 October 2026

  A former senior manager at a Kenyan bank testified, in a Sh1.5 billion data breach suit against it, that a credit manager disclosed a borrower's loan distress to a third party. He said the bank's legal department recommended no action because it saw no material risk of abuse.

Lesotho

DPI SAFEGUARDS FOR CHILDREN

- **Ramashamole Champions Safe Digital Public Infrastructure at UNGA81** — Government of Lesotho — Department of Information / Lesotho News Agency, 23 September 2026

  Lesotho's ICT ministry has developed safeguards for children in digital public infrastructure with UNICEF Lesotho and is piloting them with the National University of Lesotho across five ministries, Principal Secretary Kanono Ramashamole told side meetings at the 81st UN General Assembly. He also spoke on financing, total cost of ownership and procurement of digital public infrastructure.

Liberia

DISCLOSURE OF SOCIAL PROTECTION BENEFICIARY RECORDS

- **CDC Youth League Accuses LWSC Boss, Gender Minister of Exposing Vulnerable Children's Data, Demands Probe** — The People News Online, 12 September 2026

  Liberia's opposition CDC youth league demanded an investigation into Liberia Water and Sewer Corporation head Mohammed Ali and gender minister Gbeme Horace-Kollie. Its statement of 12 September 2026 alleges Ali posted on Facebook a spreadsheet of names, addresses, ages and schools of child abuse and neglect survivors, supplied by the minister. The allegations are the league's.

- **MGCSP Admits Authentic Beneficiary Data Leaked, Launches Internal Investigation** — Smart News Liberia, 14 September 2026

  Liberia's Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Protection confirmed on 13 September 2026 that beneficiary records from its Save the Future Project circulating on social media are authentic and were never authorised for release, and opened an internal investigation. The records concern children removed from street situations; the ministry rejected claims they list survivors of gender-based violence and said it had shared collated data with funding partners.

Malawi

UNITED STATES BILATERAL HEALTH AGREEMENT AND ITS DATA-SHARING AGREEMENT

- **US insists specimen data won't be shared** — Nation Online, 1 September 2026

  The US Embassy in Lilongwe said Malawian biological specimens will go to the United States only during public health emergencies and outbreaks, and that no personally identifiable information is shared. The agreement, signed on 11 February 2026 within a five-year US$936 million health package, requires Malawi to supply requested specimens within seven days. Malawian health advocates criticised the clause giving Malawi access to resulting products only after US domestic needs are met.

Mali

LAKANA 360 DOMESTIC SURVEILLANCE PLATFORM

- **Detecting and countering misuse of AI: September 2026** — Anthropic, 1 September 2026

  Anthropic reported in September 2026 that a Claude user, likely a Bamako-based consultant working for Mali's state security agency ANSE, used the model to build Lakana 360, a platform monitoring about 25 million SIM cards on all three national mobile operators. It collects call records, texts and voice traffic, and the warrant requirement was removed from its dossier-writing component. Anthropic said it disrupted the activity.

TOGO AND MALI DATA-PROTECTION COOPERATION AGREEMENT

- **Togo, Mali Data Regulators Agree to Share Expertise** — Togo First, 25 September 2026 TOGO

  Togo's personal data protection authority (IPDCP) and Mali's APDP signed a cooperation agreement on 23 September covering information exchange, joint handling of complaints and compliance checks, and staff training. Their talks also touched on cross-border data transfers, cybersecurity and AI.

Morocco

JUDICIAL INVESTIGATION INTO CLAIMED SPYING ON A POLITICAL PARTY'S PHONES

- **النيابة العامة بالدار البيضاء تفتح بحثا قضائيا بشأن ادعاءات التجسس على هواتف حزب سياسي** — Nichan, 14 September 2026

  Morocco's prosecutor general at the Casablanca Court of Appeal ordered a judicial investigation into a party leader's claim that his party's phones were being spied on. The national judicial police will verify the claim, which the prosecution tied to the proper conduct of the elections; the party is not named.

Mozambique

REGISTRATION AND LICENSING REGIME FOR DIGITAL PLATFORMS AND INTERMEDIARY SERVICE PROVIDERS

- **FACIM 2026: INTIC Acelera Regulamentacao Para Proteger Cidadaos no Espaco Digital** — Diario Economico, 1 September 2026

  Mozambique's ICT institute INTIC told a panel at the 61st FACIM fair in Maputo that digital platforms and intermediaries, including foreign operators serving Mozambicans, must register and declare where their data are stored. Its legal head Edson Psico said enforcing the ICT legal framework needs money, technology, staff and inspection capacity.

- **FACIM 2026: INTIC Accelerates ICT Regulation to Protect Citizens Online** — 360 Mozambique, 2 September 2026

Officials of Mozambique's National Institute of Information and Communication Technologies (INTIC) said at a panel during the 61st Maputo International Trade Fair that applying the country's ICT laws needs money, technology, staff and cooperation across sectors. Legal head Edson Psico named enforcement of data-protection rules, incident response and supervisory capacity as the main challenges, and said Mozambique depends on external technology.

PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION LAW (DRAFT)

- **Proteccao de dados nao pode travar liberdade de imprensa, alerta MISA** — Ikweli, 3 September 2026

  Press-freedom group MISA Mozambique said at a round table in Maputo that the forthcoming personal data protection law must not restrict freedom of expression, the press or access to information. The head of the national ICT institute INTIC, Lourino Chemane, said passing the law would only be a start, and institutions, enforcement and public awareness would need strengthening.

- **Mozambique | Parliament convenes extraordinary and ordinary sessions for October** — Club of Mozambique, 2 October 2026

  Mozambique's parliamentary Standing Commission on 1 October 2026 placed a Personal Data Protection draft law among 35 initial agenda items for the Assembly of the Republic's fourth ordinary session, opening on 28 October. The agenda also includes a framework law on public administration and revisions to the customs and tax procedure codes.

Namibia

UNITED STATES HEALTH DATA AND SPECIMEN SHARING PROPOSAL

- **US To Phase Out HIV Support For Namibia After Data-Sharing Impasse** — Health Policy Watch, 8 September 2026

  The United States will stop funding Namibia's HIV programme after 2027, providing $45m for fiscal 2027 for transition, after Namibia rejected US terms for sharing health data and pathogen information. Namibia has received about $1.1bn from PEPFAR over 22 years and already funds most treatment for around 220,000 people. It said the US terms conflict with constitutional privacy rights and its sovereignty over biological resources.

Nigeria

DATA PRIVACY FRAMEWORK FOR E-COMMERCE

- **Nigeria moves to enhance data privacy framework for e-commerce** — TechReview Africa, 3 September 2026

  The Nigeria Data Protection Commission began validating a Data Privacy Framework for e-commerce at an Abuja workshop run with Germany's GIZ, reported on 3 September 2026. The session, for ministries and agencies, followed a Lagos session with private firms and covered profiling and penalties under the Nigeria Data Protection Act, 2023.

RULES ON THE PROTECTION OF MINORS ONLINE

- **Nigeria To Regulate Internet Access For Children Below 16, Education Minister Announces** — Sahara Reporters, 11 September 2026

Nigeria's education minister, Tunji Alausa, said on 10 September 2026 that the government will regulate internet access for children under 16, with details to be announced by security officials within days or weeks. He also said zero-rated access should not extend to every platform calling itself educational. No rules have yet been published.

COORDINATED FRAMEWORK FOR DIGITAL-ECOSYSTEM COMPLAINTS

- **NHRC, Accountability Lab push for coordinated framework to tackle digital ecosystem complaints** — News Agency of Nigeria, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Human Rights Commission and Accountability Lab called on 16 September 2026, at a stakeholders' meeting in Abuja, for a coordinated framework to handle complaints of rights violations online. The commission's executive secretary, Tony Ojukwu, said referral routes are unclear and there are no standard procedures for preserving digital evidence. No framework or timetable was adopted.

NDPC AND NIDCOM COLLABORATION ON DIASPORA DATA-PROTECTION AWARENESS

- **NDPC and NIDCOM Partner to Strengthen Data Protection Awareness for Nigerians at Home and Abroad** — Prestige News, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's Data Protection Commission and the Nigerians in Diaspora Commission agreed to work together on data-protection awareness for Nigerians at home and abroad, during a visit by national commissioner Vincent Olatunji to the diaspora commission's chair, Abike Dabiri-Erewa. No instrument, budget or timetable is named.

NDPC REVENUE GENERATED

- **Données/Nigeria : L'Etat reprend la NDPC après plus de $9 millions de recettes générées en 3 ans** — Digital Business Africa, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's Data Protection Commission moved into a new Abuja headquarters in a building recovered by the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission, opened by communications minister Bosun Tijani on 14 September 2026. National commissioner Vincent Olatunji said the commission has generated more than N12bn (about $9m) in revenue over three years despite funding constraints.

HIGH COURT REJECTION OF IMPLIED CONSENT FOR THIRD-PARTY CONTACT DATA

- **Truecaller's Business Model and the Lagos State High Court's Rejection of the Implied Consent Argument** — DNL Legal and Style, 19 September 2026

  The High Court of Lagos State ruled on 14 September 2026, in Data Privacy Lawyers Association v Truecaller International LLP, that a Truecaller user's consent to upload contacts does not amount to consent from the non-users whose numbers are uploaded, declining to follow a 2023 Federal High Court decision. The court nonetheless refused the reliefs sought because damages were not established, applicants' counsel Olumide Babalola wrote.

- **Truecaller says Nigerians can remove their numbers after privacy ruling** — TechCabal, 28 September 2026

  Truecaller says it will not suspend or redesign its Nigerian service after the Lagos High Court dismissed a privacy suit on behalf of non-users, and points them to its unlisting portal. Judgment excerpts show the court held that a user's upload of contacts does not establish non-users' consent, and counsel for the applicants plans to appeal the refusal of relief.

META-FUNDED DATA-PROTECTION CAPACITY PROGRAMME

- **Court dismisses $25 million privacy suit against Meta in Imo** — Premium Times, 28 September 2026

Nigeria's Imo State High Court on 21 July 2026 dismissed a $25 million privacy suit against Meta, finding the applicant had not proved unlawful processing of her data, reported on 28 September 2026. Her case rested on a Nigeria Data Protection Commission order that was set aside under Meta's settlement with the commission. The court held that personal data falls under the constitutional right to privacy.

LAGOS HIGH COURT JUDGMENT ON META'S BEHAVIOURAL ADVERTISING

- **Meta appeals Nigerian ruling restricting Facebook, Instagram Ad tracking** — BusinessDay NG, 1 October 2026

  Meta filed a notice of appeal on 30 September against a Lagos High Court judgment of 25 September that held its processing of Nigerian users' data for behavioural advertising unlawful. The court ordered it to stop, comply with the data protection Act within eight weeks and pay the naira equivalent of US$100,000 in damages.

NDPC AND NATIONAL ORIENTATION AGENCY DATA-PROTECTION AWARENESS MOU

- **Nigeria's NDPC and NOA Sign MoU to Expand Data Protection Awareness** — Tech Africa News, 6 October 2026

  Nigeria's data protection commission and the National Orientation Agency signed a memorandum on joint public awareness work. It covers training for the agency's staff, coordinated campaigns across traditional and digital media, and guidance on applying the 2023 data-protection Act to the agency's own mandate.

REGISTRATION OF DATA CONTROLLERS AND PROCESSORS OF MAJOR IMPORTANCE

- **Federal High Court Upholds Mandatory Data Protection Registration for PoS Operators** — Andersen Nigeria, 9 October 2026

  Nigeria's Federal High Court in Lagos ruled on 17 July 2026 that the Nigeria Data Protection Commission acted within its powers in designating point-of-sale operators as data controllers of major importance. Such operators must therefore register with the commission and pay its fees. A PoS agent had argued the requirement breached his constitutional right to privacy.

AMERICA FIRST GLOBAL HEALTH STRATEGY MOU

- **Nigeria-US health deal under scrutiny** — Trust Radio, 12 October 2026

  Nigeria's five-year health memorandum with the United States, signed on 19 December 2025 and reported as worth about $5bn, came under scrutiny after Ghana's president said Ghana rejected a similar deal over data concerns. The deal requires Nigeria to share health data and specimens; Atiku Abubakar's campaign demanded the full text, doctors faulted a clause letting the US keep using shared data after termination, and the health ministry did not respond.

Senegal

DATA PROTECTION COMMISSION CASELOAD

- **Données personnelles : Plus de 190 dossiers traités par la CDP entre avril et juin** — Seneweb, 1 September 2026

  Senegal's personal data protection commission (CDP) handled 195 files between April and June 2026, 154 declarations and 41 authorisation requests, and issued 153 declaration receipts and 39 authorisations. It deferred two files, rejected one processing operation, heard two data controllers, and dealt with eight complaints and one report.

SEMINAR OF AFRICAN DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITIES

- **Gouvernance des données : la CDP réunit plusieurs autorités africaines à Dakar** — Agence de Presse Sénégalaise, 7 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Senegal's personal data protection commission (CDP) opened a seminar in Dakar for African and international data protection authorities, running from 7 to 10 September 2026. It is meant to strengthen cooperation and share experience on data governance, digital transformation and artificial intelligence.

PROPOSED PARLIAMENTARY INQUIRY INTO THE UNITED STATES HEALTH AGREEMENT

- **ASSEMBLÉE NATIONALE : QUATRE TEXTES GOUVERNEMENTAUX ET CINQ PROPOSITIONS D'ENQUÊTE À L'OUVERTURE DE LA SESSION ORDINAIRE 2026-2027** — Radiodiffusion Télévision Sénégalaise, 13 October 2026

  Majority deputies in Senegal's National Assembly filed a proposal for a commission of inquiry into the health cooperation agreement with the United States, in particular what it means for Senegalese personal data. The Assembly's Bureau will rule on whether it is admissible.

Seychelles

INFORMATION COMMISSION (DATA-PROTECTION AUTHORITY)

- **Information Commission trains newly appointed IOs** — Seychelles Nation, 2 September 2026

  Seychelles' Information Commission held its second 2026 induction session for information officers newly appointed by public bodies, led by chief executive Diana Benoit. The commission runs two such sessions a year.

Sierra Leone

GUARDRAILS FOR CHILDREN'S DATA IN PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Sierra Leone enhances child data protection in connected government systems** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026

  Sierra Leone is strengthening safeguards for children's personal data as government institutions move toward more connected digital public infrastructure. The communication, technology and innovation ministry, with a United Nations children's agency and a digital public infrastructure centre, ran a three-day workshop on guardrails for children examining how government systems handle their data.

South Africa

PROTECTION OF PERSONAL INFORMATION ACT AND INFORMATION REGULATOR

- **POPIA grace period limits regulator's fines** — ITWeb South Africa, 2 September 2026

  South Africa's Information Regulator called the compliance grace period the data protection Act's key weakness: a public body that remedies a violation within the stated timeframe cannot then be fined. Its chair said the high-value fines issued since enforcement powers commenced in July 2021 have largely not materialised, with bodies either complying in time or challenging in court.

- **InfoReg unpacks regulatory complexities posed by AI** — ITWeb South Africa, 17 September 2026

  South Africa's Information Regulator says artificial intelligence, automated decision-making and biometric systems have produced compliance questions its founding laws did not anticipate, naming consent, retention, transparency and the absence of a national artificial-intelligence policy. Its chairperson said the regulator is not convinced privacy by default or personal information impact assessments are being practised.

POLICE BODY-WORN CAMERAS WITH FACIAL RECOGNITION

- **SAPS wants to deploy AI bodycams with facial recognition** — TechCentral, 10 September 2026

  South African Police Service body-worn cameras must be able to conduct facial recognition, according to state IT agency tender documents. The requirement sits in the bid specification for a three-year contract covering body-worn and vehicle dashboard cameras and related software, and says the solution must also integrate with various security platforms; bids close on 29 September.

CONSUMER PROTECTION ACT DIRECT-MARKETING OPT-OUT REGISTRY

- **Commission seeks tech partners to block spam calls** — Sunday Times, 12 September 2026

  South Africa's National Consumer Commission issued a request for proposals for service providers to support its national opt-out registry for direct marketing, which it wants live in 2026, reported on 12 September 2026. Under amended consumer protection rules, marketers must register and check their lists against the registry, and face fines of up to R1 million or 10 per cent of turnover.

- **Guidelines for Compliance with Opt-Out Registry Regulations [Draft] (GN 7981)** — National Consumer Commission (South Africa), 2 October 2026

  South Africa's National Consumer Commission published draft guidelines on compliance with the opt-out registry regulations on 2 October 2026 (GN 7981), inviting comment within 15 days. Every direct marketer must register on the registry, renew annually and check its contact list against it each month it markets, at 12 cents per blocked entry.

- **National Consumer Commission launches National Opt-Out Registry** — South African Government, 7 October 2026

  South Africa's National Consumer Commission launched the National Opt-Out Registry on 7 October 2026, letting consumers block unwanted direct-marketing calls, SMSes and other messages free of charge. Direct marketers must register by December 2026 and may cleanse their lists free until April 2027; consumers can register blocks from May 2027.

Tanzania

NATIONAL ADVISORY COMMITTEE ON ONLINE CHILD PROTECTION AND SAFETY

- **Tanzania: Over 1.8 Million Children Reached in Online Safety Push** — Tanzania Daily News via AllAfrica, 1 September 2026

  Tanzania has set up a National Advisory Committee on Online Child Protection and Safety and reached 1,811,212 children with online-safety education across all 26 mainland regions, Deputy Minister Maryprisca Mahundi told the National Assembly on 31 August 2026. The committee includes the ministry responsible for ICT and will advise on strategies against online risks to children.

INSTITUTIONS REGISTERED WITH THE PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION COMMISSION

- **PDPC bolsters safeguards as personal data use expands** — The Respondents Online, 7 October 2026

  Tanzania's Personal Data Protection Commission had registered 15,146 institutions and received 445 personal-data complaints by August 2026, according to its published figures. It trained more than 300 data protection officers from public and private institutions in Morogoro on 7-8 October 2026, the eighth phase of its programme under the Personal Data Protection Act.

DATA-PROTECTION COMMISSION INVESTIGATION OF PHONE-ON-CREDIT LENDERS

- **Simu za mkopo zilivyo mateso** — Mwananchi, 17 October 2026

> Tanzania's data protection commission said it is investigating complaints about how lenders selling phones on credit collect and use borrowers' personal data. Its director general called the misuse unlawful.

Togo

> LOI N 2019-014 ON THE PROTECTION OF PERSONAL DATA

- **Protection des données : l'IPDCP appelle les administrations togolaises à accélérer leur mise en conformité** — Le Visionnaire, 15 September 2026

  The data protection authority convened ministry chiefs of staff and secretaries-general in Lome on their obligations under the 2019 personal data law and the measures needed to bring public-sector processing into conformity.

> CERTIFICATION OF DATA PROTECTION OFFICERS

- **Togo : l'IPDCP lance la certification des correspondants à la protection des données** — Le Nouveau Reporter, 5 October 2026

  Togo's personal data protection authority, IPDCP, opened its first evaluation and certification session for data protection officers in Atakpamé on 30 September 2026. Thirty-two professionals from banking, insurance, telecoms, public administration and other sectors were assessed under Law 2019-014, and only those reaching the required level may hold the title.

Tunisia

> NATIONAL AUTHORITY FOR PERSONAL DATA PROTECTION

- **Le Forum Chawki Gaddes dénonce la divulgation de données personnelles et appelle à protéger les mineurs** — Business News (Tunisia), 4 October 2026

  Tunisia's Forum Chawki Gaddes for digital rights condemned the spread on social media of personal and sensitive data, including leaked judicial documents and images of child victims. It says the national data-protection authority has stopped working although its law remains in force, and calls for it to be reactivated.

> INTERNET PROVIDER PARENTAL-CONTROL OBLIGATION

- **وزارة تكنولوجيات الاتصال: إجراءات جديدة لتوفير حماية أكبر للأطفال على شبكة الإنترنت** — Al Chourouk, 5 October 2026

  Tunisia's communications ministry announced child-protection measures resting on a telecommunications regulator's decision of 10 June 2026. Internet providers must offer parental controls covering site blacklists, device management and access-time limits, tell subscribers about them and write a child-protection clause into contracts.

Uganda

> PROSECUTIONS FOR UNLAWFUL DISCLOSURE OF PERSONAL DATA

- **Three arrested over alleged fake news, personal data offences on social media** — Nilepost, 1 September 2026

  Kampala police confirmed on 1 September 2026 that three men are held at Jinja Road Police Station over alleged fake news and unlawful obtaining or disclosure of personal data on social media in July. The case rests on Uganda's Computer Misuse Act, whose offences carry up to 10 years in prison. Police have not named the posts, platforms, victims or charges.

- **TikToker charged over alleged fake news, data disclosure** — New Vision, 7 October 2026

A TikTok user was charged in Kampala on 6 October with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data under Uganda's data protection act, and with publishing false news, over a photograph and video of a State House employee. He denied the charges; the case returns on 19 October.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION CAMPAIGN

- **Uganda Launches Child Online Protection Campaign to Promote Safer Internet Use** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026

  Uganda's communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school, to teach children to recognise and manage online risks. The ICT permanent secretary called on parents, schools, technology companies and government to share the work.

Zambia

NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION STRATEGY 2025-2029

- **Zambia launches Child Justice Week 2026 with a call to strengthen protection of children in digital spaces** — UNICEF Zambia, 7 October 2026

  Zambia's technology and science permanent secretary Brilliant Habeenzu launched Child Justice Week 2026 in Lusaka on 7 October under the theme of protecting children in digital spaces. UNICEF and Lifeline/ChildLine Zambia reported 1,208 online-safety calls and cases from January to August 2026, 85% involving children, citing addiction, harassment, cyberbullying and sextortion.

Zimbabwe

NATIONAL CHILD ONLINE PROTECTION POLICY 2026-2030

- **Zim rolling out gateways, teacher and parents training in line with the Child Online Protection Policy** — New Ziana, 10 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister, Tatenda Mavetera, told the National Assembly on 9 September 2026 that the National Child Online Protection Policy is moving to implementation. A committee with the education and social welfare ministries is installing content gateways on public free Wi-Fi and school networks so children reach only age-appropriate material; a social media ban would need further consultation.

ADMINISTRATIVE SANCTIONS UNDER THE DATA PROTECTION ACT

- **The inaugural Africa Data Protection Day** — Scientific and Industrial Research and Development Centre (SIRDC), Zimbabwe, 23 September 2026

  Zimbabwe's telecoms regulator POTRAZ held a national workshop on guidelines under the Cyber and Data Protection Act and on amendments to Statutory Instrument 155 of 2024 on administrative fines, marking the first Africa Data Protection Day on 21 September 2026, according to the research centre SIRDC. The text and status of the amendments are not given.

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